

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr wasif khan

Address: 92 Mulgrave Road Sutton SM2 6LZ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Letter of Support for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Former Sutton Ambulance Station, 18 Dorset Road, SM2 6JH

Proposed Change of Use to Place of Worship (F1) and Community Centre (F2)

Dear Case Officer,

My name is Wasif Khan and I have been a resident of 92 Mulgrave Road since 2020. My children have attended Avenue Primary School, and I am very familiar with the daily rhythms, traffic patterns, and character of this neighbourhood.

I am writing to express my support for the above planning application.

1. Understanding of the Site's Historic Use

The former Sutton Ambulance Station operated as a 24 hour emergency facility, generating frequent, unpredictable vehicle movements, rapid dispatches, and shift changes at all hours. This level of activity was an accepted part of this residential area for decades

In comparison, the proposed community and worship use will be significantly quieter, more predictable, and less intensive than the operations historically associated with the ambulance station.

2. Familiarity With School Traffic & No Overlap With Proposed Use

As a parent who has personally navigated the busy school run environment at Avenue Primary School, I understand local concerns. However, based on both my own experience and the

evidence presented:

- The proposed worship use does not coincide with morning or afternoon school peak times.
- The congregation has already demonstrated effective management of Friday prayers by staggering attendance to avoid school pickup times, and this same approach will continue at the new site

This gives me confidence that the proposal will not conflict with school traffic or pedestrian safety.

3. Proven Track Record of Safe, Responsible Operation

The congregation has been operating nearby since 2021, and over these years:

- There have been no recorded safety incidents,
- No enforcement actions, and
- No noise complaints relating to their activities.

Real world experience matters, and the evidence clearly shows that the congregation operates respectfully and integrates well with the community.

4. Real Travel Behaviour and Sustainable Transport

The Transport Statement and local operational history show:

- High levels of walking,
- Widespread car sharing,
- Regular public transport use,
- Naturally staggered arrival and departure patterns.

The proposed provision of 12 parking spaces, including 2 disabled spaces, will comfortably absorb most vehicle demand. Additional cycle racks will further encourage sustainable modes of travel. These measures demonstrate a responsible and realistic approach to transport management.

5. Clear and Meaningful Community Benefits

The proposed centre will deliver a range of positive and much needed community outcomes, including:

- Strengthening social cohesion,
- Providing space and activities for women,
- Supporting children's education and youth engagement,
- Reducing loneliness among elderly residents,
- Encouraging cultural and community integration.

The planning document recognises that the congregation is already established, the local need is real, and the proposed facility will provide significant, established, and currently unmet community benefit in this part of Sutton.

6. A Positive, Appropriate Use for a Vacant Building

The site is currently unused. The proposal would bring the space back into productive, well managed, community serving use-while generating less intensity than its historic function. This is exactly the type of community oriented redevelopment encouraged by both local and national planning policy.

Conclusion

As a long term local resident, a parent of children at the nearby primary school, and someone deeply familiar with the area, I believe this proposal is:

- Safe,
- Appropriate for the area,
- Supported by evidence, and
- Beneficial for the community.

For these reasons, I respectfully urge the Council to approve the planning application.

Yours sincerely,

Wasif Khan

92 Mulgrave Road

Sutton, SM2